

Attachment 12

Data Protection Impact Assessment

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

Janne Tukiainen | janne.tukiainen@utu.fi | Version 2.2 | 1 September 2026

Status of this assessment

This project-specific DPIA documents the planned processing and safeguards using the University of Turku structure. It will be reviewed after technical pilots, before production, and whenever the platform, collected variables, access arrangements, or risk profile changes materially.

1. Project and contact

Project: To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal.

Principal Investigator and contact for personal-data matters: Janne Tukiainen, Professor, Turku School of Economics, University of Turku;
janne.tukiainen@utu.fi.

Controller/DPO: University of Turku; dpo@utu.fi; +358 29 450 3009.

2. Nature, scope, and context of processing

The target is 300 adults who complete one laboratory session lasting approximately 60 minutes, with data collection planned for 1–31 October 2026 at UTU Choice Lab and, if needed to accelerate recruitment, Tampere DMLab. Participants remain in matching pools of 10 or 15 and are reshuffled into five-person groups. oTree records coded behavioral decisions across twenty rounds, laboratory site, pool-wide recovery or persistence assignment, group and pool identifiers, response times, payoffs, expectations, comprehension items, a study-specific consent record, eleven process questions, and twelve optional background questions. The background module records age group, gender, education, household financial strain, 2023 parliamentary vote, left–right placement, democratic support and satisfaction, strong-leader views, political efficacy, generalized trust, and risk willingness. Party vote and political-attitude responses are special-category personal data. No direct identifiers, audio, video, biometric data, health data, criminal records, or free text are collected in the interface.

Each host laboratory separately administers recruitment, attendance, and payment through its participant system: UTU Choice Lab uses UTU RPP/TOKA and DMLab uses ORSEE. A host laboratory may temporarily link an identity to a participant code. Researchers receive only coded experimental data and never receive the link; the host laboratory removes it after payment under its procedure. When DMLab is used, Tampere University independently controls its separate ORSEE administrative records. The research team stores, validates, analyses, aggregates, reports, retains coded data for compatible future research, archives anonymous outputs, and deletes data when no longer necessary. The experimental randomization affects only the fictional task and payment opportunities within the session; it creates no legal or similarly significant external decision.

3. Purpose, necessity, and proportionality

The specified purpose is scientific research on consequential institutional choice and group approval. Individual-level longitudinal decisions are necessary to observe whether the same participant changes an institutional ballot; pool and group identifiers are necessary for randomization, rematching, payoff calculation, and valid statistical uncertainty. Response times identify delays and implementation problems. Expectations and final questions check comprehension and help interpret behavioral patterns.

The design minimises data by omitting names from the interface, avoiding free text, making all

background questions optional, collecting them only after paid decisions, and limiting them to prespecified demographic, economic, political, democratic-attitude, trust, and risk constructs stated in the research plan. The research cannot answer its within-person question using anonymous aggregate counts collected only once. Coded individual records are therefore necessary, while the host laboratory's separate link, if used, permits payment and is removed afterward. Laboratory-site, matching-pool, and pool-size fields are necessary to document collection, assignment, and statistical uncertainty.

The lawful bases are scientific research in the public interest under GDPR Article 6(1)(e), Article 9(2)(j), Article 89, and sections 4(3) and 6(1)(7) of the Finnish Data Protection Act. Registration through the host laboratory's participant system records acceptance of that laboratory's general rules and privacy information. Before experimental decisions, oTree supplies project-specific information and records a concise ethical consent; this consent is not the GDPR processing basis. No data-subject right is categorically excluded in advance; requests are evaluated case by case. Data portability does not apply to a public-interest task, and Article 11 may apply after the linkage key is removed.

4. Systems, people, and data flow

1. The host laboratory recruits and schedules adults through UTU RPP/TOKA or ORSEE and assigns the code used for the laboratory session.
2. At the laboratory, the code opens oTree. Study-specific consent, its form version, timestamp, and laboratory site are recorded electronically. The host laboratory keeps any identity-to-code link separate.
3. oTree stores coded responses, treatment, interaction identifiers, response times, and payoffs on a University of Turku IT server with an `utu.fi` domain in Finland, including for DMLab sessions.
4. Janne Tukiainen, Hector Bahamonde, and authorised personnel access coded data on University IT-provided storage. The raw export becomes read-only; scripted processing creates analysis data.
5. The host laboratory administers payment separately and removes any identity-to-code link once compensation has been paid under its procedure.
6. Results are reported in aggregate. Only disclosure-checked anonymous data and code may be shared publicly.

Live data are hosted and backed up on University of Turku IT-provided servers in Finland. The public prototype is not used for live data. No transfer outside Finland or the EU/EEA is planned.

5. Rights and organisational safeguards

Participants receive clear advance information, can decline or stop, and have a study contact and DPO contact. Before paid play, laboratory staff finalise a consenting roster of 10, 15, or 20 and form fixed matching pools of 10 or 15; surplus arrivals and anyone who declines are handled under the host laboratory's procedures and never rotate into an active pool. Individual ballots are not displayed to other participants. Laboratory staff see only information needed to operate the synchronized session and payment. Researchers and staff receive confidentiality and incident-handling instructions appropriate to their roles.

Technical safeguards include participant codes, the host laboratory's separate and temporary linkage data, access control, institutional credentials, encrypted connections, two-factor authentication where available, managed backups, versioned code, audit/session logs, and secure deletion. Exports are limited to University-managed devices and UTU IT-provided storage. Small-cell outputs and combinations of site, session, pool, treatment, response, or payoff variables are assessed before release.

6. Risk assessment and controls

Risk to participant	Initial assessment	Controls and residual assessment
Unauthorised disclosure of questionnaire answers or decisions	Moderate impact; low-to-moderate likelihood	Codes rather than names, special-category handling, restricted access, encryption, no raw email transfer, aggregate reporting. Residual: low.
Linkage of experimental choices to recruitment or payment identity	Moderate impact; low likelihood	The host laboratory alone holds any separate link; researchers receive only coded data; the laboratory removes the link after payment. Residual: low.
Re-identification from pool, session, payoff, or rare response combinations	Moderate impact; low-to-moderate likelihood	No public session dates or operational labels, small-cell review, coarsening/suppression, anonymous release only. Residual: low.
Disclosure to other participants during interaction	Low-to-moderate impact; low likelihood	Private institutional and approval ballots, anonymous rematching, group totals only, no persistent identities. Residual: low.
Loss, alteration, or corruption of research data	Low-to-moderate impact; low likelihood	Read-only raw export, scripted cleaning, version control, checksums where practical, managed backups, access logs. Residual: low.
External platform access or non-EEA transfer	Moderate-to-high impact; low likelihood	Production oTree and storage on University IT servers in Finland; no live data on the public prototype; no non-EEA transfer. Residual: low.
Use of an individual choice to stigmatise or classify a participant	Moderate impact; low likelihood	No individual reporting, no consequential automated profiling, neutral instructions, debrief stating that no vote or transfer defines a person's political or moral character. Residual: low.

7. Residual risk, consultation, and review

After the stated measures, residual risk is expected to be low and proportionate to the scientific purpose. No unmitigated high risk has been identified. If a host laboratory, collected variables, access arrangements, future use, or data-subject-rights approach changes materially, or if a breach exposes a host laboratory's linkage, data collection will pause and the relevant controller/DPO will reassess the design and any need for prior consultation with the Data Protection Ombudsman.

The DPIA will be reviewed after technical pilots, immediately before production, after any material platform or data change, and if an incident changes the risk profile. Any advice from the DPO, ethics committee, host laboratories, or data services will be recorded with the final version.

Responsible researcherData Protection Officer review

Name: Janne Tukiainen

Name: _____

Date/signature: _____

Date/signature: _____

Guidance used. UTU DPIA template; GDPR Articles 6, 9, 11, 35, and 89; Finnish Data Protection Act 1050/2018, sections 4, 6, and 31.